

The Approval Router

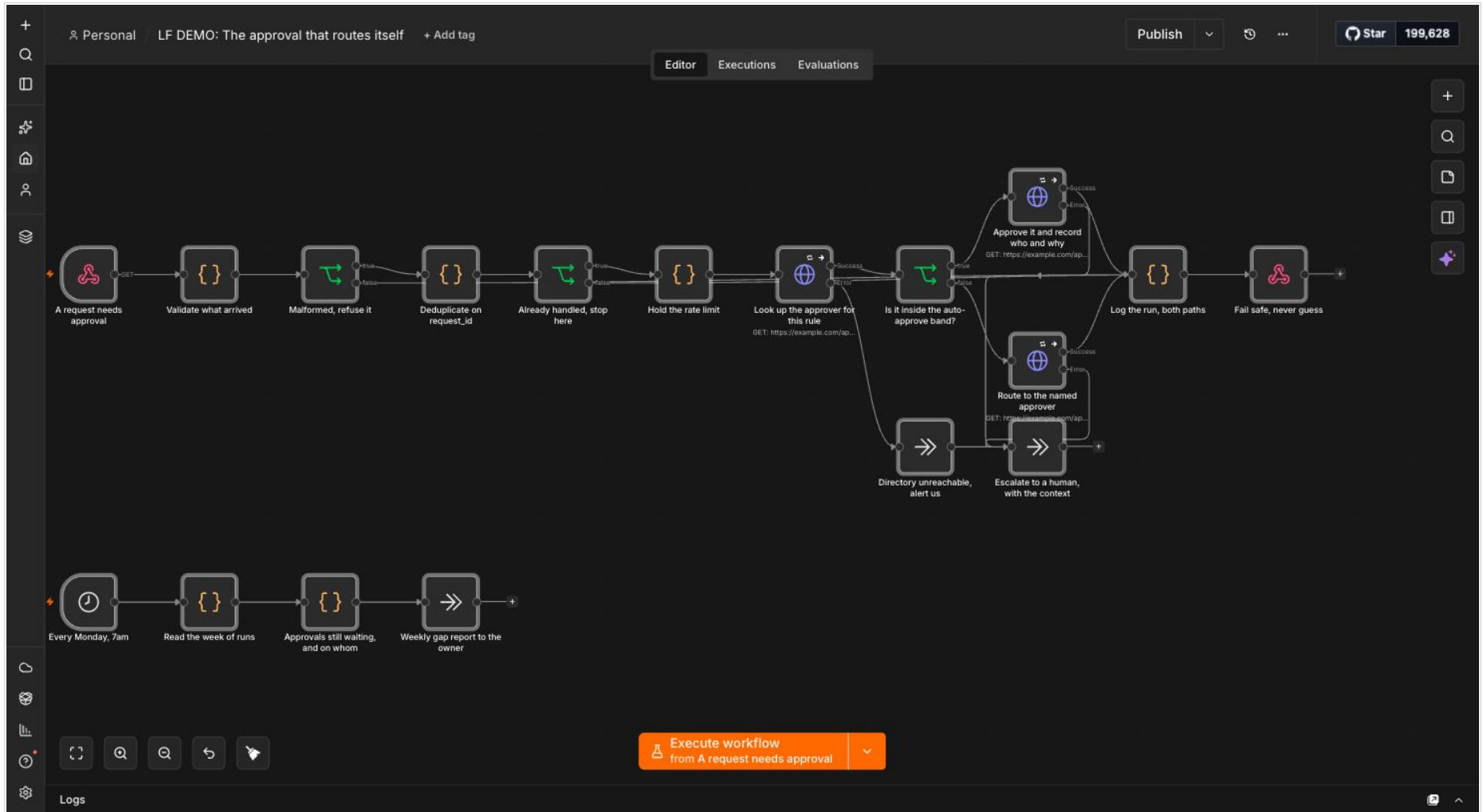
approval-routing · built in n8n

Approvals sit in an inbox with no ladder, so the bottleneck is invisible until someone asks why nothing shipped.

What it connects to: The request arrives in one place and the authority to approve lives in another. The audit trail has to span both or the band is unauditabile.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the router: auto-approve inside a band, route the rest by rule, escalate on silence.



2 of 4 THINKING

Every auto-approval records who and why, or the band becomes unauditale.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it inside the auto-approve band?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". Under "Parameters", there is a "Conditions" section with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.withinBand === true && $json.approver != null && $json.amount > 0 }}`. A dropdown menu shows "is true". Below the conditions is a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" which is currently off. There is also an "Options" section with a "+ Add option" button.

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the Parameters section, there is a text input field with the placeholder "I wish this node would...".

The interface includes a sidebar on the left with various icons and a "Logs" section at the bottom left. The top right corner has a "Docs" link and a close button.

3 of 4 RESULT

And the weekly report naming who's actually holding things up.

The screenshot shows the Zapier configuration interface for a node titled "Look up the approver for this rule". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, SETTINGS, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

SETTINGS Section: Contains configuration options for the node. The "Settings" tab is active. Options include:

- ☐ SSL Certificates
- ☐ Always Output Data
- ☐ Execute Once
- ☒ Retry On Fail
- Max. Tries: 3
- Wait Between Tries (ms): 2000
- On Error: Continue (using error output)
- Notes: (Empty text area)
- ☐ Display Note in Flow?

At the bottom of the settings section, it says "HTTP Request node version 4.2 (Latest version: 4.5)" and a link "I wish this node would...".

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "or set mock data". Above this, there are two informational messages: "This node will automatically retry if it fails" and "Execution will continue even if the node fails".

The top of the interface shows the node title, a "Docs" link, and an "Execute step" button. The bottom of the interface has a "Logs" tab.

4 of 4 MORE

And the weekly report naming who's actually holding things up.

The screenshot displays a workflow editor interface with a dark theme. At the top, a tab is labeled "Deduplicate on request_id". Below this, the interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters/Settings, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: On the left, it says "No input data" with a right-pointing arrow icon. Below this is a button labeled "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters/Settings Section: In the center, there are tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". The "Parameters" tab is active, showing a "Mode" dropdown set to "Run Once for All Items" and a "Language" dropdown set to "JavaScript". Below these is a "JavaScript" code editor with a "Code" tab and an "Ask AI" button. The code contains a deduplication logic snippet:

```
1 // The same event arrives twice more often than anyone expects.  
2 const key = $json["request_id"];  
3 const seen = $getWorkflowStaticData('global');  
4 seen.keys = seen.keys || {};  
5 const isNew = !seen.keys[key];  
6 seen.keys[key] = Date.now();  
7 return [{ json: { ...$json, isNew, dedupeKey: key } }];
```

Below the code editor is a yellow tooltip that reads: "Type \$ for a list of special vars/methods. Debug by using console.log() statements and viewing their output in the browser console." At the bottom of this section is a question mark icon followed by the text "I wish this node would..."

OUTPUT Section: On the right, it says "No output data" with a left-pointing arrow icon. Below this is a button labeled "Execute step" and the text "or set mock data".

At the bottom left of the interface is a "Logs" tab, and at the bottom right is a small icon.